of the game. We are going to reach a point where there will be enough commercial leagues for a player to have a successful career in ODIs and 20/20 without having to play Tests.

I have mixed feelings about it all, to be honest. On the one hand, the shorter format has opened the door for guys like me, Adam Gilchrist, Matthew Hayden and Andrew Symonds – all big hitters from the previous generation who have now been given a bit of a second wind. As 20-over 'mercenaries', it's been a really lucrative innovation for us too. It's funny how the wheel has turned. As youngsters the only route to fame and fortune was to work your butt off to get into the Test team – and even then the South African guys were a little bitter because they were getting paid peanuts compared to their colleagues in the English Test squad. Convert into rands what those guys earned in pounds and it was like chalk and cheese.

On the other hand, I do feel a little sad to see the new-generation youngsters disregard Test cricket. It's a form of the game that tests strength of character and resolve like no other. Only in Test cricket do you get enough twists and turns to keep you on the edge of your seat for days. The downside of 20/20 cricket is that the game can pretty much be decided in the first five overs of the first innings if the team opening the innings has a 'mare. So, ja, I think gone are the days when a young cricketer starts out with a hunger for Test cricket and sets as his goals those golden milestones of 100 Tests or 10 000 Test runs.

Neither will these young pups get the opportunity to play epic games against the likes of the great Aussie teams under Steve Waugh and Ricky Ponting. Even though they klapped us most of the time, it's a genuine highlight of my career to have played against one of the best teams in Test cricket (along with that legendary West Indian team of the late 1970s and 1980s). I get a real sense of accomplishment knowing that I was able to score Test runs against bowlers such as Shane Warne and Glenn McGrath. Gary Kirsten and I were chatting about this recently – Eric Simons was with us too – and we're proud to say that we held our own in Test cricket and were able to make our mark in the limited-overs game as well. Not like these youngsters nowadays who have become so specialised.

Young Australian David Warner is the perfect example of the new breed of international cricketer. He's an explosive batsman the likes of which we haven't really seen before – he's like me, times two. When he comes off, he